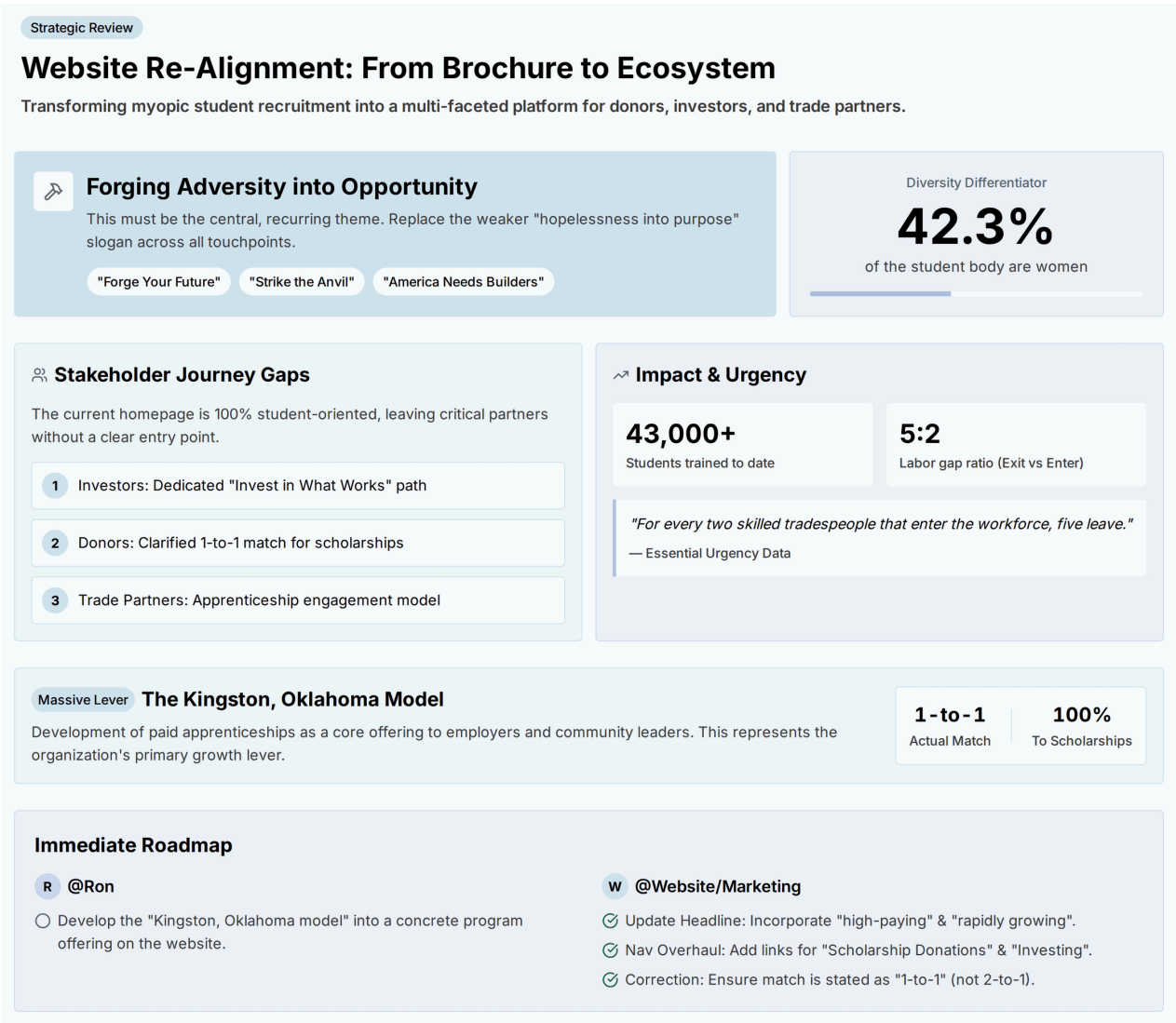


06-18 Reasoning Note: Website Strategic Review and Action Plan



lost, and we are leaving our most valuable potential partners without a clear path to engagement.

Strategic & Tactical Review of the Website

1. Messaging Hierarchy Inversion

The current messaging is misaligned with the primary strategic points. Key messages are either absent from the homepage or lack prominence.

- **Primary Message (Must Elevate):** “Forging adversity into opportunity.” This needs to be the central, recurring theme. The current “hopelessness into purpose” is weaker and should be replaced.
- **Supporting Pillars (Need Integration):**
 - “Strike the anvil, ignite the spark.”
 - “America needs builders again.”
 - “43,000+ students trained.”
- **Slogan Consolidation:** The team should standardize on “forge your future” instead of the current “build your future” for brand consistency.

2. Homepage Structural Deficiencies

The homepage is 100% student-oriented, which silos the user experience and fails to capture other critical stakeholders.

- **Missing Calls-to-Action:** The top-level navigation must include clear entry points for non-student audiences. Specific links are needed for:
 - Scholarship Donations
 - Investor Relations (“Interested in investing?”)
 - Trade Partner Apprenticeships
- **Content & Data Placement:**
 - **Headline:** The headline “Future Proof Your Career..” is a good start but could be stronger by integrating the “high-paying, rapidly growing” concept.
 - **Labor Gap Data:** The statistic that “for every two skilled tradespeople that enter the workforce, five leave” should be added to the welder section to create urgency.
 - **Community Focus:** The phrase “There’s a place for you here” should be strengthened by explicitly mentioning “community” as the heart of the

organization.

- **Diversity Statistic:** The fact that “women make up 42.3% of the student body” is a powerful differentiator and should be made bold, underlined, or placed in a more prominent lead position.

3. Disconnected Stakeholder Journeys

The paths for donors and partners are confusing and inefficient, requiring a dedicated and simplified user flow.

- **Donor & Investor Path:** The “Invest in what works” section is good but hard to find. A direct link from the top navigation is necessary. This link should direct inquiries straight to the speaker.
- **Donation Clarity:** The donation page must be simplified.
 - It should explicitly state that **100% of donations fund student scholarships**. This bifurcates philanthropic gifts from for-profit investments.
 - The matching claim must be corrected to **“one-to-one,”** not “two-to-one,” to reflect the actual matching structure accurately.
- **Apprenticeship Model:** The Kingston, Oklahoma model for creating paid apprenticeships represents a massive lever for the organization. This needs to be built out as a core offering on the site, targeting employers and community leaders. The current “employers and community leaders” section is insufficient and requires significant development.

Next Move

@Ron

- [] Develop the “Kingston, Oklahoma model” into a concrete program offering on the website to attract trade partners for internships and apprenticeships [TBD]

@Website/Marketing Team

- [] Replace “build your future” with “forge your future” across all site copy [TBD]
- [] Revise the main headline to be stronger, incorporating “high-paying” and “rapidly growing” [TBD]
- [] Add the “5 leave for every 2 that enter” statistic to the welder section [TBD]
- [] Explicitly add the word “community” to the section “there’s a place for you here” [TBD]

- [] Make the “42.3% of students are women” statistic bold, underlined, or otherwise more prominent [TBD]
- [] Integrate the core messaging hierarchy (“Forging adversity into opportunity,” “Strike the anvil,” etc.) onto the homepage [TBD]
- [] Replace “hopelessness into purpose” with “forging adversity into opportunity” [TBD]
- [] Add top-level navigation links for: “Scholarship Donations,” “Interested in Investing?,” and “Trade Partner Apprenticeships” [TBD]
- [] Ensure the “Invest in what works” link for investors and philanthropists directs inquiries directly to the speaker’s contact [TBD]
- [] Update the donation page to state that donations are matched “one-to-one” and that 100% of funds go to scholarships [TBD]
- [] Consider replacing the student stories section with Cage’s story as the primary example [TBD]